

Password Policy

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Policy Owner	Information Security Officer
Department	Information Technology
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1. Purpose

This policy sets the rules for creating, using and protecting passwords and other authentication methods, so that Beacon's systems and data are protected from unauthorised access.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all employees, contractors and vendors who have a Beacon user account, and to all systems, applications and devices used for Beacon work, in the office or remotely.

3. Password Requirements

Requirement	Standard
Minimum length	12 characters
Complexity	At least 1 uppercase letter, 1 lowercase letter, 1 number and 1 special character
Expiry	Every 90 days
Reuse	Last 5 passwords cannot be reused
Account lockout	After 5 failed attempts, locked for 30 minutes
Screen lock	Automatically after 5 minutes of inactivity
Privileged (admin) accounts	Minimum 16 characters, changed every 60 days
Service accounts	Minimum 20 characters, managed by IT, rotated every 180 days

4. Main Rules

4.1 Creating Passwords

1. Passwords must not contain the employee's name, username, date of birth or the word "Beacon".
2. A passphrase of several unrelated words with numbers and symbols is recommended.
3. Passwords created for Beacon systems must not be used on any personal or other website.
4. Default or temporary passwords must be changed within 24 hours of first login.

4.2 Protecting Passwords

- Passwords must never be shared with anyone, including managers, colleagues and IT staff. IT will never ask for your password.
- Passwords must not be written on paper, sticky notes or stored in browsers or plain files.
- Employees should use the company-approved password manager, BeaconVault, to store passwords.

4.3 Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)

1. MFA is mandatory for company email, VPN, the Beacon People Portal, the Beacon Finance Portal, the code repository and all cloud consoles.
2. The approved MFA method is the company authenticator app. SMS codes are allowed only as a backup.
3. Remote employees must complete MFA each time they connect to the VPN (see BT-IT-003).
4. If an MFA device is lost or replaced, the employee must contact the IT Service Desk immediately. Access is restored after identity verification.

4.4 Password Reset

- Employees can reset their password through the self-service portal using MFA.
- If self-service is not possible, call the IT Service Desk at extension 4000 or write to itservicedesk@beacon-tech.example. Identity will be verified before reset.

4.5 Shared Accounts

Shared or generic accounts are not allowed. Each person must use their own account.

4.6 Compromised Credentials

If a password or MFA device may be compromised, the employee must change the password immediately and report it within 2 hours as an incident under BT-IT-005.

5. Exceptions

- Legacy systems that cannot support these rules may be given a time-bound exception by the Information Security Officer, for a maximum of 6 months, with compensating controls.
- Exceptions are recorded and reviewed every 3 months.

Internal Use Only

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Synthetic document created for a technology prototype.